Cybersecurity Assessment 02

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Report scope: Task B — fictional message analysis (25 marks)

Task B — Analyse a suspicious message

Assessment: The text contains strong phishing warning signs. These justify caution, but do not prove that a real sender or website is malicious. All addresses are fictional; none were visited.

B1. Five specific warning signs (10 marks)

Relevant phrase from the evidence	Why it needs scrutiny
"awards@campus-awards.example"; "help@personal-awards.example"	Neither domain matches the college's usual campus.example. The different Reply-To also redirects replies elsewhere. A legitimate external provider is possible, but needs independent confirmation.
"FINAL WARNING"; "expires in 20 minutes"	Urgency and threatened loss pressure the student into acting before checking the claim.
"enter your college password and OTP"	Requests both a login secret and a second factor. Sharing these could enable account access or approval of an attacker-initiated action.
"Do not contact the college office"	Discourages independent verification, using alleged system unavailability as an excuse.
"Reply with a photo of your identity card"	Requests sensitive identity information through an unverified channel, creating impersonation and privacy risks.

B2. Safe verification (5 marks)

1. Do not click, reply, upload identification or enter credentials. Preserve the message for reporting.
2. Open the college portal through an existing trusted bookmark or independently obtained official address. Use a telephone number from a college handbook or established directory to contact the scholarship office; avoid contact details supplied in the message.
3. Ask whether the award, deadline and external domains are authorised. Check the scholarship status inside the official portal. If the office is unavailable, wait for verified contact instead of following the message's deadline.

HTTPS encrypts the connection to a domain; it does not establish college affiliation or honest intent. A familiar display name such as "Scholarship Desk" can be chosen or copied by a sender.

Task B — Response and limits

B3. Password and OTP already entered (7 marks)

4. Immediately stop interacting with the message and suspicious page. From a trusted device, independently open the official account portal and change the password. Change it on any other accounts where it was reused, using unique passwords.

5. Sign out all sessions and revoke unfamiliar devices or app access. Contact college IT immediately to invalidate sessions or tokens, review MFA and reset compromised factors. A password change or expired OTP alone may not end an existing attacker session.

6. Report through the college's established IT/security channel and notify the scholarship office. Provide the original message, timestamps and actions taken; never send passwords or OTPs. Mention any identity-card image shared.

7. Review sign-in history, recovery details, MFA registrations, mailbox forwarding rules and scholarship/payment details. Ask IT to reverse unauthorised changes, monitor further alerts and confirm recovery. Warn affected contacts if the account sent fraudulent messages.

B4. An unresolved fact (3 marks) The message alone cannot establish who actually sent it. The original email with full headers, trusted mail-server authentication results and independent college confirmation would help assess origin and authorisation. Even successful email authentication would not itself prove college affiliation.

Source boundary: This is a text-based assessment of the supplied evidence. No external sources were consulted, no domains were visited and no live sender or website investigation was performed.